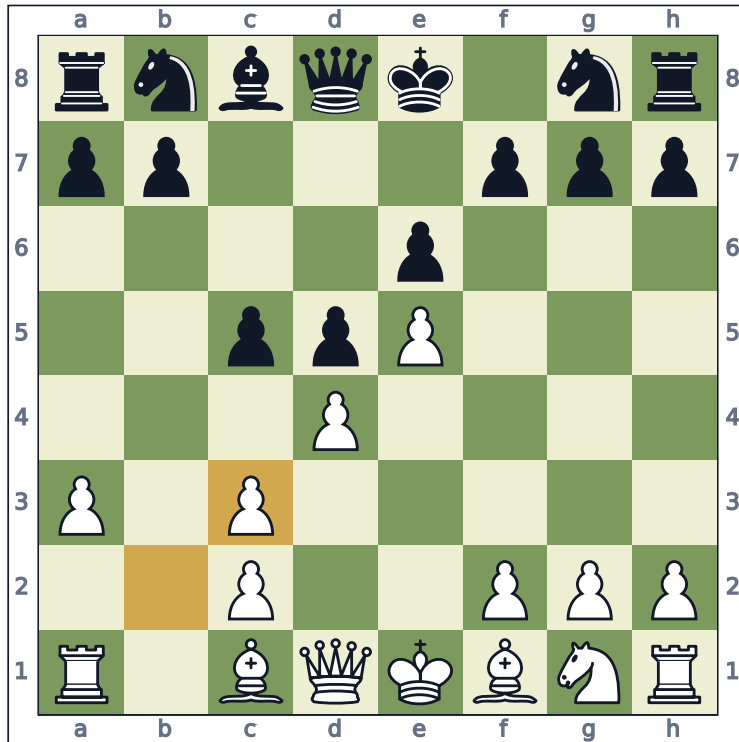


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense

ECO C18 | 16 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.63 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C18 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c3, Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C18 line

This section preserves all 16 names and defining routes assigned to C18 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3

002 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7

003 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation, with Bd3

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Bd3

004 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation, with Bd3

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Bd3 Qc7

005 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation, with h4

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. h4

006 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Advance Variation, with h4

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. h4 Qc7

007 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Classical Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Qc7

008 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Eingorn Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 Kf8

009 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Poisoned Pawn Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 Qc7

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

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010 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Poisoned Pawn Variation
 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 cxd4 8. Qxg7

011 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Poisoned Pawn Variation
 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 cxd4 8. Qxg7 Rg8 9. Qxh7 Nbc6

012 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Poisoned Pawn Variation Declined
 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 Qc7 8. Bd3

013 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Poisoned Pawn Variation, Main Line
 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 Qc7 8. Qxg7 Rg8 9. Qxh7 cxd4 10. Ne2

014 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Poisoned Pawn Variation, Paoli Variation
 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 Qc7 8. Qxg7 Rg8 9. Qxh7 cxd4 10. Kd1

015 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Portisch-Hook Variation
 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Qa5

016 French Defense: Winawer Variation, Warsaw Variation
 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 c5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3 Ne7 7. Qg4 O-O